Another maneuver is the stupendous amount of money allocated to the Orthodox parties in the projected state budget to be discussed in two weeks. This means severe cuts in ordinary state expenses such as education and health services. What is going on in all domains is hard to believe. It is clear that Smotrich, as finance minister, is behind all of this. There is a common front between all of the Orthodox parties in favor of their own interests, and against the needs of the state.

Monday, May 8

European Union diplomats have canceled the reception to avoid a speech by Ben-Gvir. In the meantime, the tension surrounding the debates on the budget is growing, as Ben-Gvir continues to boycott the various Knesset forums. Even Smotrich has called on him to show good will for the sake of the common cause. I guess that he will wait until he is offered adequate compensation. In the meantime, he managed to restore to the service a policewoman who was found guilty of having attacked a Palestinian woman.

Tuesday, May 9

The army liquidated three of the most senior military commanders of Islamic Jihad in the Gaza Strip. A reaction is expected, and security measures have been taken in the villages and towns within a given perimeter around Gaza.

A second attack in Gaza, against a unit that was about to fire anti-aircraft guns. In the first attack against Islamic Jihad, ten civilians were killed in addition to the three commanders; in the second, two civilians lost their lives. The UN has condemned this, but that is irrelevant; they will automatically condemn Israel. The question is: was the first attack